

Threat Landscape Analysis: Flutterwave

1. Organization and Sector Identification

1.1 Organization Overview

Flutterwave is a financial technology and payments company that provides payment infrastructure and APIs for businesses. Its platform supports multiple use cases, including payments for fintech companies, banks and other financial institutions, e-commerce businesses, remittance services, and telecommunications companies.

Flutterwave's payment services include payment collection, transfers, payment links, subscriptions, and other payment-related services. Its documentation also shows that its platform processes financial transactions through APIs and other technical integrations.

In April 2026, Flutterwave announced that it had obtained a Nigerian Microfinance Banking licence. According to the company, the licence enables it to hold funds and deposits directly and expand its financial-services infrastructure in Nigeria.

1.2 Selected Sector

Financial Services — Fintech and Digital Payments

Flutterwave's operations place it within the financial-services ecosystem because its infrastructure supports payment processing, transfers, financial accounts, and other financial services. Its own documentation describes fintech operations as involving transaction processing, customer accounts, and fund transfers.

Primary references:

- [Flutterwave Developer Documentation](#)
- [Flutterwave — Fintechs](#)
- [Flutterwave — Payments Help Center](#)
- [Flutterwave — Nigerian Banking Licence Announcement](#)

2. Threat Landscape Affecting the Financial Services Sector

Financial institutions and payment organizations operate highly technology-dependent environments in which the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of information and financial systems are important security requirements.

The **Central Bank of Nigeria (CBN)** identifies evolving cybersecurity threats against financial institutions, including **phishing, ransomware, and Distributed Denial-of-Service (DDoS)**

attacks. The CBN notes that financial institutions need to proactively protect critical information assets against these persistent threats.

The **Nigeria Computer Emergency Response Team (ngCERT)** has also reported a rise in high-impact cybersecurity incidents affecting organizations across Nigeria. Its April 2026 advisory identifies **phishing, ransomware, Business Email Compromise (BEC), and data breaches** among the observed threats and notes the increasing use of cybercrime-as-a-service and AI-enabled techniques.

A subsequent August 2026 ngCERT advisory specifically highlights **Business Email Compromise, phishing, impersonation, and social-engineering attacks**, explaining that attackers may use compromised accounts and trusted identities to manipulate organizations into transferring funds, changing payment details, or disclosing sensitive information.

Threat	Relevance to Financial Services
Phishing	Can be used to obtain credentials or deceive employees/customers
Ransomware	Can disrupt systems and operations while enabling extortion
Business Email Compromise	Can facilitate fraudulent financial transfers and payment-detail manipulation
DDoS	Can affect the availability of online financial services
Data breaches	Can expose sensitive customer or organizational information
Social engineering	Can exploit employees, customers, trusted identities, and business processes

References:

- [Central Bank of Nigeria — Risk-Based Cybersecurity Framework](#)
- [ngCERT — Escalating Cybersecurity Threats and Ongoing Attacks Targeting Organisations in Nigeria](#)
- [ngCERT — Business Email Compromise and Social Engineering Attacks](#)

3. Threat Actors Relevant to the Sector

3.1 FIN7

FIN7 is a financially motivated threat group that has been active since at least 2013. MITRE ATT&CK records FIN7 as having targeted multiple industries, including the **financial services** industry.

MITRE also documents FIN7's use of point-of-sale malware and its later shift toward ransomware operations, including the use of REvil and DarkSide-related ransomware.

Relevant ATT&CK activity includes:

- Phishing and malicious files/links
- PowerShell
- Valid Accounts
- Windows Management Instrumentation
- Scheduled Tasks
- Screen Capture
- Data from Local System
- Data Encrypted for Impact **Reference:**
- MITRE ATT&CK — FIN7 (G0046)

3.2 FIN8

FIN8 is a financially motivated threat group that has been active since at least 2016. MITRE records FIN8 as targeting organizations in several sectors, including the **financial sector**. MITRE also documents FIN8's transition from targeting point-of-sale devices to distributing ransomware variants.

Relevant techniques documented by MITRE include:

- **T1566.001 — Phishing: Spearphishing Attachment**
- **T1566.002 — Phishing: Spearphishing Link**
- **T1059.001 — PowerShell**
- **T1078 — Valid Accounts**
- **T1003.001 — OS Credential Dumping: LSASS Memory**
- **T1486 — Data Encrypted for Impact**
- **T1560.001 — Archive Collected Data: Archive via Utility**
- **T1071.001 — Web Protocols **Reference:****
- MITRE ATT&CK — FIN8 (G0061)

3.3 Carbanak

Carbanak is a cybercriminal group associated with attacks against financial institutions. MITRE documents the group and its associated Carbanak malware separately and records multiple techniques used during its operations.

MITRE identifies **Carbanak (S0030)** as a remote backdoor capable of providing remote access and supporting activities such as data exfiltration. MITRE records both FIN7 and the Carbanak group as users of the Carbanak software.

Relevant techniques include:

- **T1078 — Valid Accounts**
 - **T1219 — Remote Access Software**
 - **T1547.001 — Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder**
 - **T1059 — Command and Scripting Interpreter**
 - **T1055 — Process Injection**
 - **T1113 — Screen Capture**
 - **T1003 — OS Credential Dumping** **References:**
 - [MITRE ATT&CK — Carbanak Group \(G0008\)](#)
 - [MITRE ATT&CK — Carbanak Malware \(S0030\)](#)
-

4. Commonly Observed Malware and Tools

The research identifies several malware and tools associated with financially motivated threat actors relevant to the sector.

Carbanak

Carbanak is a remote backdoor associated with financial-sector attacks. MITRE describes it as capable of remote access, espionage, and data exfiltration.

Point-of-Sale Malware

FIN7 has historically used point-of-sale malware as part of its targeting operations.

Ransomware

Both FIN7 and FIN8 have documented ransomware activity. MITRE records FIN7's use of ransomware in its later operations and FIN8's deployment of ransomware variants including Ragnar Locker and White Rabbit.

Tools used by threat actors

MITRE also documents legitimate and dual-use tools associated with these groups, including:

- PowerShell
- WMI

- RAR
- Cobalt Strike
- Remote-access software

These should not automatically be considered malicious by themselves; their significance depends on **how they are used in an attack**

5. MITRE ATT&CK Techniques / TTPs

The following techniques are examples documented by MITRE for the threat actors examined:

ATT&CK ID	Technique	Associated actor
T1566.001	Phishing: Spearphishing Attachment	FIN8
T1566.002	Phishing: Spearphishing Link	FIN8
T1059.001	Command and Scripting Interpreter: PowerShell	FIN7 / FIN8
T1078	Valid Accounts	FIN7 / FIN8 / Carbanak
T1003.001	OS Credential Dumping: LSASS Memory	FIN8
T1486	Data Encrypted for Impact	FIN7 / FIN8
T1560.001	Archive Collected Data: Archive via Utility	FIN8
T1219	Remote Access Software	Carbanak
T1547.001	Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder	Carbanak

6. Targeting Patterns and Initial Access

The available intelligence indicates several recurring patterns relevant to financially motivated attacks.

Phishing and social engineering

FIN7 and FIN8 have documented use of phishing techniques, including malicious links, attachments and documents.

Credential abuse

Valid credentials are documented as an attack technique for FIN7, FIN8 and Carbanak. This demonstrates the importance of credential security within financial environments.

Malware and ransomware

Financially motivated groups may use malware to establish access, collect information, maintain persistence, or ultimately deploy ransomware. FIN7 and FIN8 provide documented examples of this progression.

Payment-related targeting

The financial sector's dependence on payment systems, customer accounts and transaction infrastructure creates potential targets for attackers seeking financial gain or operational disruption. CBN's cybersecurity framework specifically identifies payment systems and electronic channels as critical systems whose compromise or unavailability can cause significant financial and operational consequences.

7. Flutterwave-Specific Security Incident

A company-specific incident should be distinguished from general sector threats.

On **May 16, 2024**, Flutterwave published a statement concerning a security incident it had detected in April 2024.

According to Flutterwave:

- Unauthorized activity was detected on one of its platforms.
- The platform was used by a small subset of its customer base.
- Flutterwave's security team investigated the activity.
- The company stated that customer funds were not lost or compromised.
- The company stated that customer-data confidentiality remained intact.
- For a professional report, this should be described as a **documented security incident involving unauthorized activity**, rather than being characterized as a confirmed data breach or loss of customer funds, because Flutterwave's own statement does not support those claims.

Reference:

- [Flutterwave — Information Regarding a Recent Security Incident](#)
-

8. Threat Landscape Summary

The research indicates that Flutterwave operates within a highly technology-dependent financialservices environment involving payment processing, transfers, financial accounts and APIs. Consequently, sector-level threats such as phishing, ransomware, BEC, DDoS and data

breaches are relevant to the organization's threat landscape. Nigerian cybersecurity authorities have highlighted several of these threats, while MITRE ATT&CK documents financially motivated threat groups such as FIN7, FIN8 and Carbanak whose activities include targeting financial organizations.

The 2024 Flutterwave security incident provides a company-specific example of unauthorized activity and demonstrates why monitoring, threat intelligence, access control and incident response are relevant to the organization.

9. Key References

For your **Obsidian/reference section**, these are the core sources used:

1. **Flutterwave Developer Documentation** — company platform, APIs and supported industries.
[Flutterwave Developer Documentation](#)
2. **Flutterwave — Fintechs** — fintech operations and financial-service infrastructure.
[Flutterwave Fintech Documentation](#)
3. **Flutterwave — Information Regarding a Recent Security Incident** — 2024 companyspecific incident.
[Flutterwave Security Incident Statement](#)
4. **Flutterwave — Nigerian Banking Licence Announcement** — 2026 expansion into microfinance banking.
[Flutterwave Banking Licence Announcement](#)
5. **Central Bank of Nigeria — Risk-Based Cybersecurity Framework** — financial-sector cybersecurity threats and critical systems.
[CBN Risk-Based Cybersecurity Framework](#)
6. **Nigeria Computer Emergency Response Team (ngCERT) — Escalating Cybersecurity Threats** — Nigerian threat landscape.
[ngCERT Cybersecurity Threat Advisory](#)
7. **ngCERT — Business Email Compromise and Social Engineering** — BEC, phishing and impersonation threats. [ngCERT BEC and Social Engineering Advisory](#)
8. **MITRE ATT&CK — FIN7 (G0046)** — threat actor, targeting and techniques.
[MITRE ATT&CK — FIN7](#)
9. **MITRE ATT&CK — FIN8 (G0061)** — threat actor, financial-sector targeting and techniques.
[MITRE ATT&CK — FIN8](#)
10. **MITRE ATT&CK — Carbanak (G0008)** — threat actor and documented techniques.
[MITRE ATT&CK — Carbanak Group](#)
11. **MITRE ATT&CK — Carbanak (S0030)** — malware and associated threat actors.
[MITRE ATT&CK — Carbanak Malware](#)

OpenCTI Representation

Threat Actor Profile: FIN7

Entity Type: Intrusion Set

Confidence Level: 2 – Probably True

Active Since: 2013

Description:

FIN7 is a financially-motivated threat group targeting retail, hospitality, financial services, and several other sectors, primarily in the United States. Early operations were conducted through a front company (Combi Security) using point-of-sale malware; since 2020, the group has pivoted to "big game hunting," deploying REvil and its own Darkside ransomware-as-a-service. FIN7 shares tooling with the Carbanak group, but the two are tracked as distinct entities due to multiple actors using Carbanak's toolkit.

Possible Alias/Related Group: Carbanak (tracked separately in OpenCTI due to shared tooling across multiple actors)

Technique ID	Name	FIN7 Usage
T1566.001	Phishing: Spearphishing Attachment	Sent malicious Microsoft Office/RTF attachments
T1210	Exploitation of Remote Services	Exploited ZeroLogon (CVE2020-1472)
T1113	Screen Capture	Captured screenshots/desktop recordings
T1587.001	Develop Capabilities: Malware	Built infected removable media
T1567.002	Exfiltration to Cloud Storage	Exfiltrated data via MEGA
T1558.003	Kerberoasting	Used Invoke-Kerberoast for credential access/lateral movement

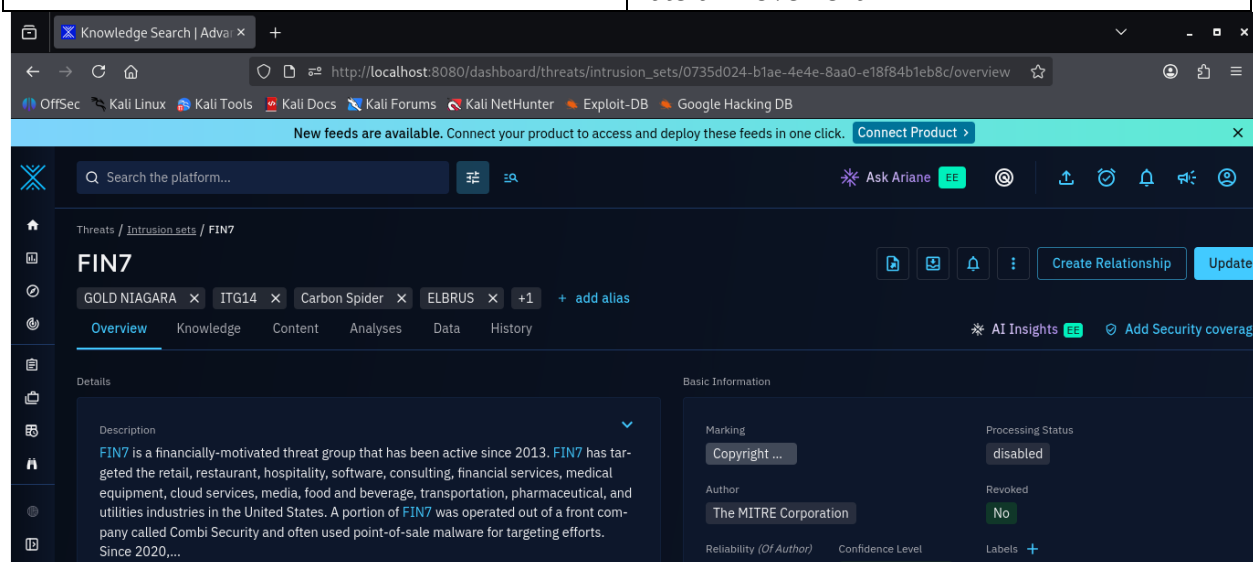
Associated Malware

Name	Notes
BOOSTWRITE	Custom loader malware
SystemBC	Proxy/backdoor malware
TEXTMATE	FIN7-associated malware

Associated Tools

Name	Purpose
Mimikatz	Credential dumping

PowerSploit	Offensive PowerShell framework (persistence, exfil, evasion)
CrackMapExec	Post-exploitation, Active Directory recon, lateral movement



Threat Actor Profile: FIN8

Entity Type: Intrusion Set

Confidence Level: 2 – Probably True **Active**

Since: January 2016

Description:

FIN8 is a financially-motivated threat group targeting hospitality, retail, entertainment, insurance, technology, chemical, and financial sectors. Historically focused on point-of-sale (POS) device compromise, FIN8 pivoted in mid-2021 toward deploying ransomware variants.

Mapped ATT&CK Techniques (Attack Patterns)

Technique ID	Name	FIN8 Usage
T1047	Windows Management Instrumentation	Uses WMI/WMIC and Impacket for lateral movement, malware execution, and postcompromise cleanup
T1016.001	System Network Config Discovery: Internet Connection Discovery	Uses Ping to verify C2 connectivity

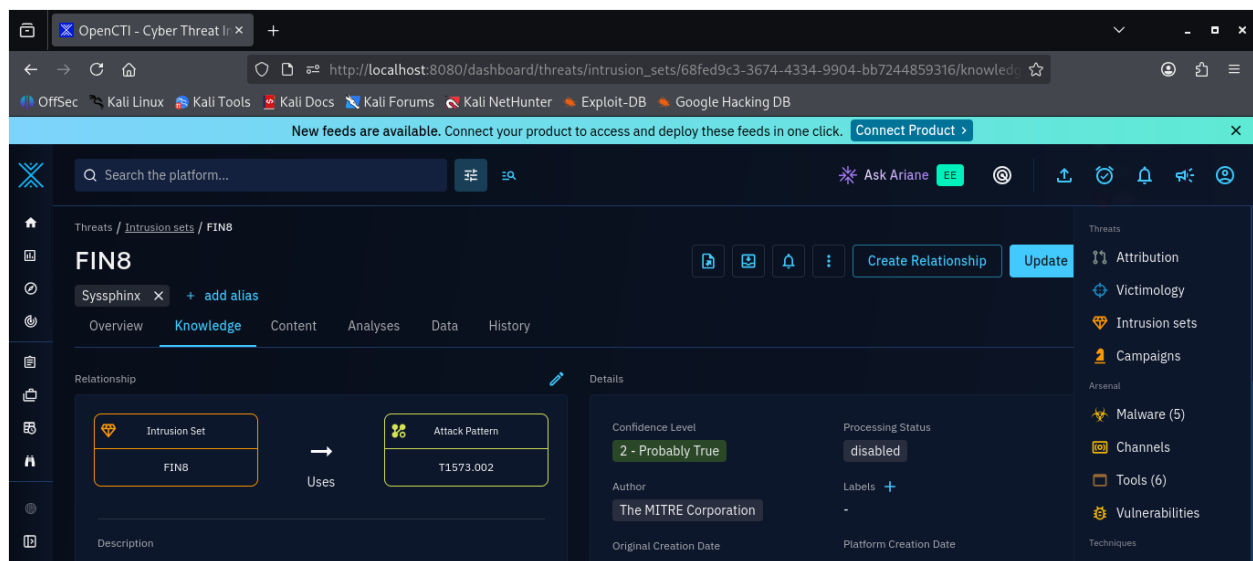
T1134.001	Access Token Manipulation: Token Impersonation/Theft	Uses a malicious framework to impersonate the lsass.exe/vmtoolsd.exe token
T1112	Modify Registry	Deletes Registry keys during post-compromise cleanup
T1486	Data Encrypted for Impact	Deployed Ragnar Locker, White Rabbit ransomware; attempted Noberus execution
T1482	Domain Trust Discovery	Retrieves trusted domain lists via nltest.exe /domain_trusts
T1573.002	Encrypted Channel: Asymmetric Cryptography	Uses Plink utility to tunnel RDP back to C2 infrastructure

Associated Malware

Name	Notes
BADHATCH	Custom backdoor, signature FIN8 tool
Sardonic	Backdoor/framework
Ragnar Locker	Ransomware variant
PUNCHTRACK	POS-targeting malware
PUNCHBUGGY	POS-targeting malware

Associated Tools

Name	Purpose
PsExec	Remote execution
Impacket	Lateral movement toolkit
Ping	C2 connectivity checks
Nltest	Domain trust/AD enumeration
Net	Windows network/account enumeration
dsquery	Active Directory querying



Threat Actor Profile: Carbanak

Entity Type: Intrusion Set

Alias: Anunak

Confidence Level: 2 – Probably True

Active Since: 2013

Description:

Carbanak is a cybercriminal group that has used Carbanak malware to target financial institutions since at least 2013. Carbanak may be linked to groups tracked separately as Cobalt Group and FIN7, which have also used Carbanak malware.

Relationship Note: Confirms what FIN7's profile flagged — Carbanak is tracked as a distinct group in OpenCTI even though tooling overlaps with FIN7, since multiple actors have used the Carbanak malware.

Mapped ATT&CK Techniques (Attack Patterns)

Technique ID	Name	Carbanak Usage
T1588.002	Obtain Capabilities: Tool	Obtained and used open-source tools like PsExec, Mimikatz
T1686	(Firewall rule modification)	Uses <code>netsh</code> to add local firewall rule exceptions
T1543.003	Create/Modify System Process: Windows Service	Installs Carbanak malware as a service for persistence + SYSTEM privileges

T1036.005	Masquerading: Match Legitimate Name	Named malware "svchost.exe" to mimic the legitimate Windows process
T1219	Remote Access Software	Used legitimate tools (AmmyyAdmin, TeamViewer) for remote interactive C2

Associated Malware

Name	Note
Carbanak	Full-featured remote backdoor; used for espionage, data exfiltration, and remote access

Associated Tools

Name	Purpose
PsExec	Remote execution
Mimikatz	Credential dumping
netsh	Firewall rule manipulation

Knowledge Search | Adv...

http://localhost:8080/dashboard/threats/intrusion_sets/7eff1832-4c2d-4cf4-8a10-11346b9eabeff/overview

OffSec Kali Linux Kali Tools Kali Docs Kali Forums Kali NetHunter Exploit-DB Google Hacking DB

New feeds are available. Connect your product to access and deploy these feeds in one click. [Connect Product](#)

Search the platform...

Ask Ariane

Threats / Intrusion sets / Carbanak

Carbanak

Anunak + add alias

Overview Knowledge Content Analyses Data History

AI Insights Add Security coverage

Description

Carbanak is a cybercriminal group that has used Carbanak malware to target financial institutions since at least 2013. Carbanak may be linked to groups tracked separately as Cobalt Group and FIN7 that have also used Carbanak malware.(Citation: Kaspersky Carbanak)(Citation: FireEye FIN7 April 2017)(Citation: Europol Cobalt Mar 2018)(Citation: Secureworks GOLD NIAGARA Threat Profile)(Citation: Secureworks GOLD KINGSWOOD Threat Profile)

Marking

Copyright ...

Author

The MITRE Corporation

Reliability (Of Author)

Confidence Level

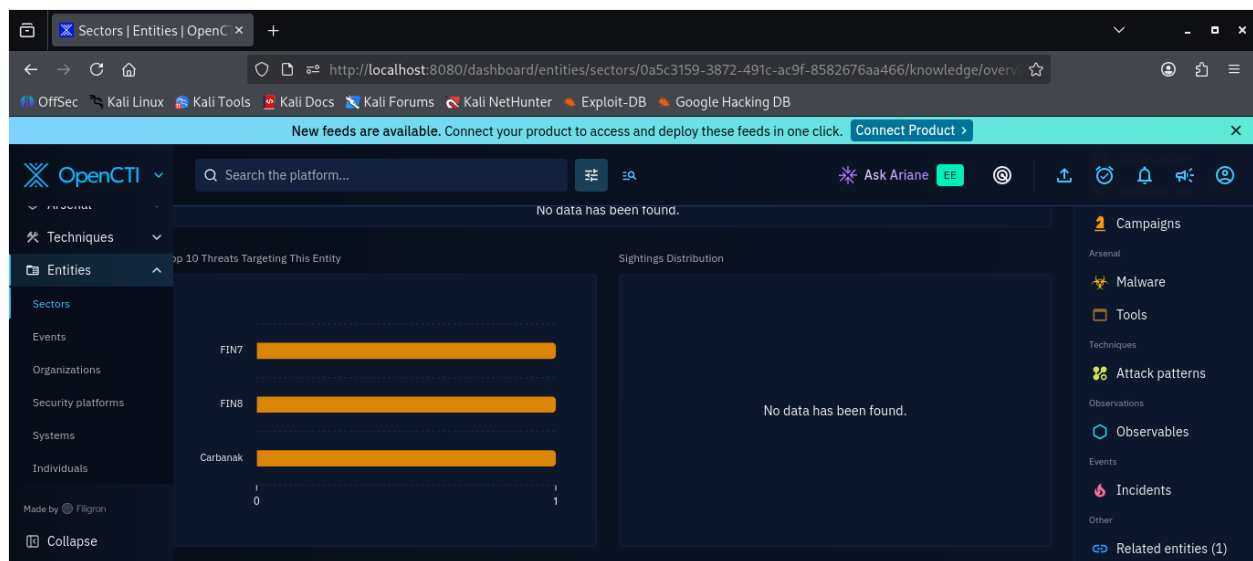
Processing Status

disabled

Revoked

No

Labels



Notable Historic Incidents — Flutterwave

February 2023: Unauthorized actors transferred approximately ₦2.9 billion (~\$4.2 million) across 28 accounts in 63 transactions.

Reference:

<https://techcrunch.com/2023/03/05/alleged-security-breach-leaves-millions-of-dollars-missing-fromflutterwave-accounts/>

March 2023: A separate incident saw ₦550 million diverted to 107 accounts across 27 banks.

Reference:

<https://www.techloy.com/flutterwave-hit-by-n11-billion-cybersecurity-breach-claims-customer-fundsnot-affected/>

October 2023: Unauthorized POS transactions resulted in ₦19 billion (~\$24 million) transferred to 6,000 accounts across 35 banks.

Reference:

<https://www.itedgenews.africa/flutterwave-hit-again-by-major-cybersecurity-breach-with-billionsdiverted/>

April 2024: Unauthorized activity was detected on an internal platform, resulting in ₦11–20 billion (~\$7M–\$13.5M) diverted across 5 financial institutions over four days. **Reference:**

<https://thewillnews.com/flutterwave-loses-n11bn-to-security-breach/>

Pattern Observed

All four incidents involved unauthorized fund transfers through compromised accounts or transactions rather than direct theft of customer data. In the April 2024 incident, perpetrators reportedly kept individual transactions below fraud-detection thresholds to avoid triggering alerts, indicating a degree of operational sophistication and prior knowledge of the platform's fraud controls.

Reference:

<https://www.techloy.com/flutterwave-hit-by-n11-billion-cybersecurity-breach-claims-customer-fundsnot-affected/>

Preferred Victims / Targeting Pattern

The incidents consistently targeted transaction-processing and payment-disbursement systems rather than customer-facing accounts directly. Commentary on the February 2023 incident suggested the attack may have stemmed from compromised merchant API keys, pointing toward credential theft or social engineering as a likely initial access method.

Reference:

<https://rss.boorghani.com/?p=167716>